

HRRP Meeting Minutes

District Meeting Minute, Kavrepalanchok

Date: 02 March 2016

Time: 11:00 AM-12:30 PM

Venue: DDC Meeting Hall, DDC Office Kavrepalanchok

Chaired By: Tek Raj Niraula (LDO, DDC Kavrepalanchok)

HRRP District Focal Point: Pabitra Basnet Email: pabitra@hrrpnepal.org

HRRP District IM: Panch Dev Bhatta Email: panch@hrrpnepal.org

Participants: DDC Kavrepalanchok, Navjyoti Centre, Mercy Corps, Build Change, Handicap International, DUDBC Kavrepalanchok, Caritas Nepal, Habitat for Humanity Nepal, ARSOW Nepal, Terre Des Hommes, KIRDARC Nepal, Deupur Reconstruction Committee, Prerana, NRCS, IOM/HRRP

Agendas

1. Welcome and introduction
2. Updates from National HRRP Meeting
3. Agency Updates
4. Open discussion
5. AOB
6. Tentative date for next meeting

1. Welcome and Introduction

1.1 Welcome

The HRRP Coordination meeting took place at the DDC Meeting Hall, DDC Office Kavrepalanchok on 2nd March 2016. The first session of the meeting was chaired by the LDO of Kavrepalanchok district Mr. Tek raj Niraula and second session was chaired by DE, DUDBC Kavrepalanchok Mr. Asta Lal Suwal. The formal meeting started with a brief introduction of every participants followed by the issues mentioned in agenda facilitated by HRRP District Coordinator Ms. Pabitra Basnet. There was update from the national HRRP meeting that took place on 18 February 2016 at Kathmandu and the updates from the meeting of HRRP technical team with NRA by Pabitra Basnet and Mr. Suman Joshi, HRRP Eastern Hub Coordinator followed by agency updates and open discussion. A total of 18 participants representing 13 organizations including government, NGOs, INGOs were present at the HRRP meeting.

1.2 Introduction

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This was the Second HRRP meeting conducted in Kavrepalanchok district. Its main objective was to discuss on the issues, problems and challenges in housing related projects in Recovery and Reconstruction at Kavrepalanchok districts and also update the information from the national HRRP team and the NRA. The meeting was organized in order to have a direct interaction with the DDC, DDRC, DUDBC, HRRP team and the POs working in Recovery and Reconstruction in district which could come up with some common understanding and issues that can be raised out at national level and some issues that can be sorted at local level.

2. Updates from National HRRP Meeting

Ms. Pabitra Basnet, DFP for HRRP Kavrepalanchok shared the updates from the National HRRP meeting held on 18 February 2016. The key updates shared by the DFP were:

- Partially Damaged HHs can be repaired and they would get the subsidy as per the level of damage
- New houses can be built in the foundation of the old houses but should be under the supervision of technical person
- Technology matters more than design during the construction of new HHs
- People wanted to be guided not controlled
- NRA requests for the support from POs in enrollment process of Resource Centres. The piloting of resource centre is supposed to start at Laduk and Lamidada VDCs of Dolakha district (25 Feb to 15 March)
- Pilot testing of IEC materials
- POs submit the HRRP 4Ws to district HRRP team
- Government doesn't want direct support from POs for HHs reconstruction, prefers the training, capacity building and technical support

3. Agency Updates

This was the second meeting of the HRRP in district level at Sindupalchok, the agencies were sharing the problems they were facing because of the confusion created due to NRA's recent press release.

DUDBC Sindupalchok: All the agencies need to follow the instructions by NRA. Those agencies which have already got permit to work and started their work may continue but all other agencies which have asked for the permit is kept in hold until a clear message from the NRA is obtained addressing DUDBC. DUDBC is managing the database of the masons that have already received the training after getting approval from them before the press release by NRA.

DDRC DFP: DDRC have stopped approving the pre consensus letter to POs which have affected the development of proposals for the Recover and Reconstruction. This would have a long-term effect on the Reconstruction phase and will lead extra burden to government in future as well. If any organization is willing to support marginalized poor, the NRA concern might affect them as the POs are bonded by the law, not to support those people.

Habitat for Humanity (HfH): HfH was planning for support of construction materials in blanket approach but after the recent scenario and unclear vision by NRA, they are in confusion whether to keep their plan in or shift their plan to other sectors besides housing.

Build Change: Preparing for Training Resource centre (Housing Service Centre), developing materials but confused whether to start or not as the approval is pending in DDRC and none of the DDRC, DUDBC or NRA is giving approval to conduct the activities. Applied for VDCs to work but

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are not sure how and where they can work. The regular work of DUDBC have stopped and NRA also haven't started their work which has created a big gap in Recovery Work.

NRCS Kavre: They have already received the consent letter to construct 11,600 HHS, the construction approval agreement with passed through DDRC by NRCS in 14 districts before the press release by NRA and after the recent press release from NRA regarding the prohibition for direct support for construction of HHs. They are now in confusion because of the NRA's new press release to stop the organisations to construct the HHs directly.

4. Open Discussion

- POs willing to know the system and authorizing body for the approval to start their work. They are technically ready but are not getting the approval in time which is affecting their planned activities.
- NRA is not accepting letter for approval and DUDBC is not authorized to give the approval currently.
- Land ownership problem may arise during enrolment process as there are many landless and marginalized poor people in the community.
- During enrolment process there may be more than expected beneficiaries, so this thing should be kept in mind while identifying the beneficiaries.
- Some POs are willing to build individual HHs for the marginalized pre-poor so NRA could rethink in its strict decision if possible.

5. AOB

There was an appeal by a member of Deupur Reconstruction Committee member, Er. Shankar Dhakal that he and his committee (comprised of 200 members including multiparty members, technical people) would support in technical aspects if any donor agency is willing to work with them in Recovery and Reconstruction.

5.1 Updates from NRA

During the communication working group meeting held at NRA on 24th February 2016, NRA shared some issues that would provide some guidelines and messages to communicate with HRRP POs in district

1) The reconstruction policy and the eligible criteria have been approved by steering committee

2) Reconstruction policy covers issues related to

- a. Rural housing, settlements, local infrastructures
- b. Urban housing, settlements and heritages sites
- c. Community buildings and large scale infrastructures

3) NRA has approved two eligibility criteria for housing grant

- technical – houses categorized as G3 or above by damage assessment survey will receive the grant
- Social and legal criteria (not clear yet) – the final document will be shared by NRA

4) Installments

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- a. There will be three installments, the first installment (25% amount) will be provided through bank accounts after having MoU between house owner and V.D.C
- b. The second installment will be provided after the technical inspection during plinth level construction (40%)
- c. The final installment will be provided during the lintel level (35% amount) after the inspection from technical person

5) Organizational framework

There will be a central project implementation unit at Kathmandu, the central PIU will report to NRA and to the line ministries.

Under PIU at central level, there will be district PIU.

6) Partners shouldn't provide housing grants directly to the people, the grant should go through NRA. For other work related to reconstruction, partners are requested to do the tripartite agreement between NRA, line ministry and partners. However, for small projects partners can directly do the MoU with district PIU that will be again tripartite agreement.

7) Resource centers will be established at districts covering 3-5 V.D.Cs, a government officer will lead the resource centers, and however it will be managed and supported by POs where partners are available

5.2 POs are invited to make the presentation on their activities related to Housing Recovery and Reconstruction in coming HRRP meetings.

Action Points

- NRA should give a clear vision on the approval authority body and the significance of DUDBC at district level
- HRRP team should communicate the problems faced by the POs at district level to the NRA and get through a solution
- The gap created because of the confusion among the government bodies and NRA should be addressed and the gap should be filled up as soon as possible
- In any confusion regarding the NRA and issues in R&R POs can have a direct conversation with the Executive member of NRA [Mr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha- 9841298970](mailto:Mr.ChandraBahadurShrestha@nra.gov.np) at office hours in working days.

Next Meeting

The next HRRP meeting at Kavrepalanchok is **tentatively scheduled on 16th March 2016** Wednesday at DDC Meeting Hall, DDC Office Kavrepalanchok. (In case date changes POs will be informed prior to the meeting). POs are requested to check the HRRP website for latest updates on meetings, resource materials and NRA updates.

[http:// http://hrrpnepal.org/meetings/meetings-calendar/](http://http://hrrpnepal.org/meetings/meetings-calendar/)

Meeting Participants List/Attendance Sheet

Name	Designation	Agency	Agency Type	Contact Number	Email ID
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